had seemed so vital to Einstein and Bohr were dismissed by the new crop of American physicists as dreamy trifles, hardly suitable as subjects of inquiry to be funded by the rivers of money flowing from the Pentagon.

But not all American physicists were pragmatic enough to swallow the Copenhagen interpretation. “Bohr’s principle [complementarity] puts nature on the fence and leaves it there,” grumbled Henry Margenau, a philosophically minded physicist working at Yale. “It relieves its advocates of the need to bridge a chasm in understanding by declaring that chasm to be unbridgeable and perennial; it legislates a difficulty into a norm.” One American physicist in particular was destined to cause serious trouble for the Copenhagen interpretation. He had worked with Oppenheimer at Berkeley during the war and was recruited by Princeton shortly thereafter. In 1947, David Bohm arrived at Princeton, a freshly minted assistant professor. He had accepted the Copenhagen interpretation in his career to date, but soon he would be irritated by pesky doubts. Within five years, those doubts ballooned into a full-scale personal rebellion against the quantum orthodoxy. David Bohm was about to do the impossible: defy von Neumann’s proof, shock John Bell out of the uneasy peace he had made with Copenhagen—and change quantum physics forever.